

Complex Sentences and Clauses

Year 5 | Grammar and Phonics

Aussie Primary
Academy

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 | AC9E5LA05 | Year 5 | Understanding Language — Complex Sentences

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to identify and construct complex sentences using main and subordinate clauses.

KEY IDEA

A complex sentence has a **MAIN** clause (complete idea) and a **SUBORDINATE** clause (depends on the main clause). Subordinate clauses begin with conjunctions: because, although, when, if, since, while, unless, until.

WARM UP — QUICK CHECK!

Underline the main clause. Circle the subordinate clause:

'Although it was raining heavily, the children played outside.'

A — MAIN OR SUBORDINATE?

Label each part **MAIN** or **SUBORDINATE** clause:

1. 'Because she studied hard' —

clause

2. 'The team won the match' —

clause

3. 'While the kettle boiled' —

clause

4. 'She smiled with relief' —

clause

B — JOIN THE CLAUSES

Example: She finished her homework.
She watched TV. → After she finished her homework, she watched TV.

1. Combine using 'because': The match was cancelled. It was raining.

2. Combine using 'although': He was tired. He kept running.

3. Combine using 'since': She moved here. They have been great friends.

C — WRITE YOUR OWN

Write 3 complex sentences using a different subordinating conjunction each time (when, since, if):

D — FIX THE FRAGMENT

A fragment is an incomplete sentence. Add a main clause to complete each one:

1. 'Because the storm was approaching,'

2. 'Although she was nervous,'

3. 'When the lights went out,'

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Main clause: 'the children played outside'. Subordinate clause: 'Although it was raining heavily'.

A1: Subordinate

A2: Main

A3: Subordinate

A4: Main

B1: The match was cancelled because it was raining.

B2: Although he was tired, he kept running.

B3: Since she moved here, they have been great friends.

C: Accept any 3 grammatically correct complex sentences using when, since, if correctly.

D1: Accept e.g. 'Because the storm was approaching, we packed up the picnic quickly.'

D2: Accept e.g. 'Although she was nervous, she stepped onto the stage.'

D3: Accept e.g. 'When the lights went out, everyone stopped talking.'

High Five! You are a Language Champion! ✓
Colour a star for each section you completed successfully:



EXTENSION / CHALLENGE

Find 3 complex sentences in a book you are reading. Write them out, underline the subordinate clause in each and identify the subordinating conjunction used.

PARENT TIP

When reading together, ask: 'Which part is the main idea? Which part depends on it?' Point out subordinating conjunctions — this builds sentence-level comprehension skills.

TEACHER TIP

Use sentence strips for students to physically combine main and subordinate clauses. Display a subordinating conjunction word bank on the classroom wall and add to it throughout the term.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- ☐ I can identify main and subordinate clauses in complex sentences
- ☐ I can combine simple sentences into complex sentences using conjunctions
- ☐ I can write my own complex sentences using subordinating conjunctions